

» ARACHNIDS



FUNNEL-WEB SPIDER
Atrax robustus
F: Atacridae

Females of this aggressive Australian spider live in burrows with funnel-like, silk-lined entrances. The dangerous bite most frequently comes from males wandering for mates.



MEXICAN RED-KNEED TARANTULA
Brachypelma smithi
F: Theraphosidae

This is one of many theraphosids: large-bodied spiders popularly called bird-eaters or tarantulas. They prey on large insects, rarely on small vertebrates.



CHACO TARANTULA
Acanthoscurria insubtilis
F: Theraphosidae

Many large theraphosids, such as this S. American species, live in disused rodent burrows. They are ambush predators, lying in wait for prey.



NORTH AMERICAN TRAPDOOR SPIDER
Ummidia audouini
F: Halonoprocidae

This N. American spider builds a cork-like trapdoor set with trip-lines. Stumbling prey alert the predator waiting in a silk-lined burrow beneath.



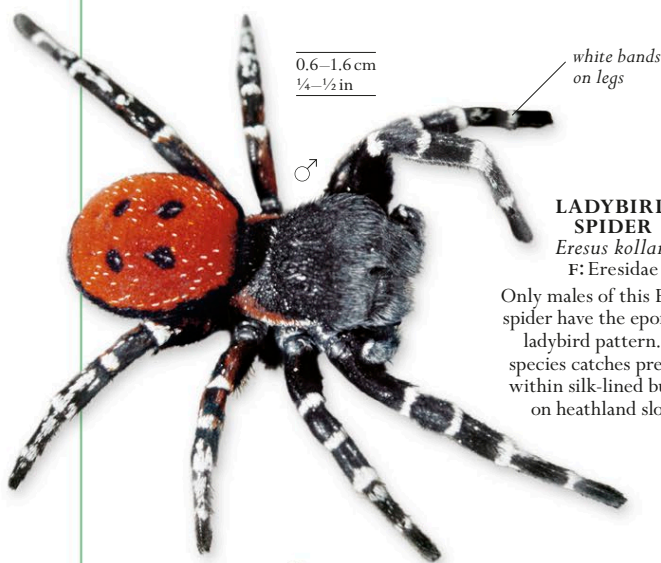
SIX-EYED SPIDER
Oonops domesticus
F: Oonopidae

This tiny, pink, six-eyed spider occurs in warm parts of Eurasia, but further north – including in Britain – it is found only in houses.



WOODLOUSE SPIDER
Dysdera crocata
F: Dysderidae

This nocturnal European spider has huge fangs that catch and break into the hard exoskeletons of woodlice. It occurs in damp places where woodlice are abundant.



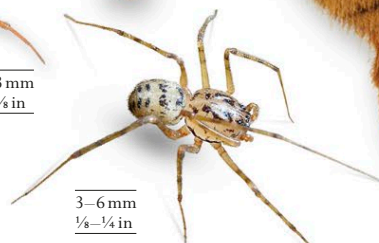
LADYBIRD SPIDER
Eresus kollari
F: Eresidae

Only males of this Eurasian spider have the eponymous ladybird pattern. This species catches prey from within silk-lined burrows on heathland slopes.



DWARF SPIDER
Gonatium sp.
F: Linyphiidae

Typical of a very large family of tiny “money spiders”, this northern hemisphere species builds sheet webs and can travel in wind by ballooning on silken threads.



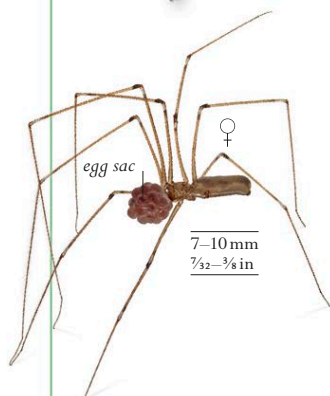
NORTHERN SPITTING SPIDER
Scytodes thoracica
F: Scytodidae

Spitting spiders are sluggish spiders that spray gummy, poisonous fluid to immobilize prey before biting. This species spans the northern hemisphere.



EUROPEAN GARDEN SPIDER
Araneus diadematus
F: Araneidae

A weaver of orb webs from the northern hemisphere, this spider of woodland, heath, and gardens is marked by a white cross on a variable background colour.



DADDY LONG-LEGS SPIDER
Pholcus phalangioides
F: Pholcidae

Spindly-legged pholcids vibrate their webs when disturbed. Many are cave dwellers, but this cosmopolitan species inhabits houses. Females carry eggs in their jaws.



AMERICAN GOLDEN SILK ORB-WEAVER
Trichonephila clavipes
F: Araneidae

This is the only American species of a group of tropical golden orb-weavers. It is distinguished by feathery tufts on its legs.



CRAB-LIKE SPINY ORB-WEAVER
Gasteracantha cancriformis
F: Araneidae

One of many American orb-weavers with defensive spines, this species inhabits the S. USA and the Caribbean. Colours of the body and spines vary.

forward-pointing
chelicerae carrying fangs

eight small eyes

pedipalp

5–6 cm
2–2½ in

hairy, brown
body

spinnerets
extrude silk

4–13 mm
½–1½ in

2–9 mm
⅛–1½ in

0.6–4.5 cm
¼–1½ in

3 mm
⅛ in

3–6 mm
⅛–¼ in

0.6–1.6 cm
¼–½ in

white bands
on legs

2–5 cm
¾–2 in

5–7.5 cm
2–3 in

5–7.5 cm
2–3 in